Digital Literacy: Project Report

CSE0001 — Digital Literacy

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1. Introduction

This project report documents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course. The assignment required building a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio across five modules — covering visual content creation, professional online presence, exploration of coding and collaboration platforms, professional email communication, and cybercrime awareness. Each task was designed to develop a specific digital competency essential for a modern engineering student. All work has been organised in a single GitHub repository, and this report provides detailed reflections on each task, the tools used, challenges faced, and key learnings. Through this project, I gained practical, hands-on experience with tools and platforms that I will continue to use throughout my four-year degree and beyond.

2. Task 1 — Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I created a one-page infographic titled "Digital Literacy 101: Your Essential Guide" using **Canva**, a free, browser-based graphic design platform. I chose Canva because of its drag-and-drop interface, extensive template library, and professional-quality output which was great for me as was an individual with no prior design experience.

The infographic covers three core topics:

(1) **What digital literacy means**: Going beyond basic computer skills to encompass the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information responsibly using digital technologies.

(2) **Essential digital tools for students**: GitHub for code collaboration, Google Workspace for cloud productivity, Canva for design, and LinkedIn for professional networking.

(3) **Safe internet practices**: These include using strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, recognising phishing attempts, and protecting one's digital footprint.

One thing I found particularly interesting was how much thought goes into the design. Deciding what to emphasise, which colours convey trust and clarity (I used a blue-and-white palette), and how to organise information so that a reader can scan it in seconds, which I had not considered before.

3. Task 2 — Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up professional profiles on three platforms: **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Stack Overflow** — chosen because they are the most relevant to a Computer Science student's academic and career growth.

On **GitHub**, I created a profile README in a special repository named after my username. This README includes my name, branch (CSE), year (First Year), and a sentence about my learning goals which was building a strong foundation in programming and contributing to open-source projects. GitHub will serve as my primary code portfolio, where every project I build over the next four years will be visible to recruiters and graduate admissions committees.

On **LinkedIn**, I filled in my Education section with my current degree (B.Tech CSE), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year (2029). I also added a professional headline. LinkedIn will help me connect with alumni, discover internship opportunities, and document professional milestones and showcase it to the world.

On **Stack Overflow**, I created a profile on the world's largest Q&A community for programmers. Stack Overflow is where real-world coding problems are solved every day, and reading answers here builds debugging skills faster than any textbook. I plan to start by searching for solutions to problems I encounter in my coursework and gradually contribute answers to beginner-level questions.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively maintain all three profiles — making regular commits on GitHub, expanding my LinkedIn network with meaningful connections, and building my Stack Overflow reputation by contributing quality answers.

4. Task 3 — Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For Task 3, I explored two categories of platforms: a coding practice platform and a cloud collaboration tool.

Part A — Coding Practice: I chose **HackerRank** and completed the "Solve Me First" challenge in the Algorithms → Warmup track using Python. While the problem itself was straightforward (computing the sum of two integers), the experience taught me how online judges work — reading input from standard input, processing it through a defined function, and validating output

against expected results. This is fundamentally different from running code locally, and it gave me confidence to attempt more complex algorithmic challenges. I captured screenshots of my completed challenge and any badges awarded.

Part B — Google Forms Quiz: I created a five-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using **Google Forms**. The quiz includes both multiple-choice and short-answer questions, covering topics like the definition of digital literacy, password strength, phishing awareness, coding platforms, and the national cybercrime helpline number. I shared the quiz link in the README and took screenshots of both the form and the linked Google Sheet response view. Designing the quiz made me appreciate how cloud collaboration tools like Google Forms enable instant data collection and analysis — a skill valuable for surveys, feedback, and research throughout my academic career.

5. Task 4 — Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

For Task 4, I drafted two professional emails and created a social media etiquette checklist.

Email 1 was a request from a student to a professor for an assignment submission extension. I structured it with a clear subject line ("Request for an extension on assignment submission."), a respectful greeting, a concise explanation of the reason (sickness), an acknowledgement of the inconvenience, and a professional sign-off with full contact details. **Email 2** was an expression of interest in a summer internship, addressed to a company's internship coordinator. It included my academic background, relevant skills, enthusiasm for the role, and a formal closing.

I also created a **Social Media Do's and Don'ts** checklist with five items in each category. Key do's include thinking before posting, maintaining professional profiles, and verifying information before sharing. Key don'ts include sharing personal details publicly, engaging in cyberbullying, and posting impulsively under emotional distress.

One scenario that illustrates the importance of digital communication etiquette: a student once sent a casual, poorly written email to a professor requesting a grade review, using slang and no subject line. The professor, perceiving the lack of effort and respect, declined to review the request. Had the student used a proper subject line, respectful tone, and structured body, the outcome might have been entirely different. This example underscores that how you communicate online is just as important as what you communicate.

6. Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

For Task 5, I researched **Cyberbullying**, a crime which is in a form of online harassment where individuals use digital platforms such as social media, messaging apps, or online forums to threaten or humiliate someone.

While researching cyberbullying, what surprised me the most was how common it is globally and how quickly it can escalate from a single comment into widespread harassment. The idea that nearly one in five internet users are affected which shows that this is not just an isolated issue but a serious and growing problem. I was also surprised by how cyberbullying is more harmful than traditional bullying because it can happen at any time and reach a large audience instantly.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is being more mindful of my online behavior. I will think carefully before commenting or sharing content and ensure that my actions do not negatively impact others. Additionally, I will be more cautious about engaging in online trends that may unintentionally target or harm someone.

I also created a comprehensive **Stay Safe Online** prevention checklist with actionable tips, including two specifically about UPI/financial safety, and included the emergency reporting channels — the **National Cyber Crime Portal** (cybercrime.gov.in) and the **24×7 Helpline 1930**.

7. Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project was a genuinely valuable learning experience that went far beyond theoretical knowledge. Through five interconnected tasks, I gained practical skills in visual design (Canva), professional networking (LinkedIn, GitHub, Stack Overflow), collaborative cloud tools (Google Forms), email communication, and cybersecurity awareness. The most impactful takeaway was understanding UPI fraud — a threat that is deceptively simple yet affects millions of Indians every year. Building this portfolio also taught me the importance of organising work in a structured, professional repository — a skill I will carry forward into every future project. I now feel significantly more prepared to navigate the digital world safely, professionally, and effectively.

8. References

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